Responsive Double

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A responsive double is used after partner makes a takeout double. It occurs when:

1. Your left-hand opponent ("LHO") opens a suit,
2. Partner makes a takeout double, and
3. Your right-hand opponent ("RHO") raises.

A double in this situation shows at least 4-4 shape in:

- the **major** suits if the opponents bid a *minor*, or
- the **minor** suits if the opponents bid a *major*.

Examples

♠A543 ♥QT98 ♦5 ♣Q652	LHO 1♦	Partner Dbl	RHO 2♦	You Dbl[1]

(1) A responsive double, showing both majors. Partner is asked to bid 2♥ or 2♠.

♠964 ♥52 ♦AQ53 ♣AJ84	LHO 1♥	Partner Dbl	RHO 2♥	You Dbl[1]

(1) A responsive double, showing both minors.

♠K964 ♥5 ♦KT53 ♣A984	LHO 1♥	Partner Dbl	RHO 2♥	You 2♠[1]

(1) Do NOT make a responsive double if you can bid a 4-card major instead.

♠5 ♥543 ♦KJT65 ♣AKJT	LHO 1♠	Partner Dbl	RHO 3♠	You Dbl[1]

(1) A responsive double, advertising both minors.

Responsive Doubles After an Overcall

Some pairs also play responsive doubles opposite an overcall:

♠K54 ♥T7 ♦AT73 ♣K652	LHO 1♠	Partner 2♥	RHO 2♠	You Dbl[1]

(1) A responsive double, denying heart support but promising both minors.

Other Considerations

In their excellent book "Modern Bridge Conventions", Bill Root and Richard Pavlicek suggest these HCP minimums for a responsive double:

- 6+ points at the 2-level
- 8+ points at the 3-level
- 10+ points at the 4-level

They also suggest playing responsive doubles up to 4♦, although many partnerships play them through 3♠ instead.

Origins

Root and Pavlicek attribute responsive doubles to American player Dr. F. Fielding-Reid.

See also

- Lightner Double
  A lead-directing double of an enemy slam contract.
- Low-Level Penalty Double
  A double of an enemy partscore that isn't artificial, e.g. takeout.
- Maximal Double
  A conventional double used as a major suit game try.
- Negative Double
  A conventional double used by responder after opener starts the bidding with one-of-a-suit and the next player makes a suit overcall.